



# How recovery experiences shape nurses' perceptions of workplace mistreatment: A multilevel daily diary study



Taeuk Jeon, Seonmi Yoon, Sun-ha Kim, Seohyun Ji, & Sunhee Lee  
(Department of Psychology, Chungnam National University, Daejeon, South Korea)

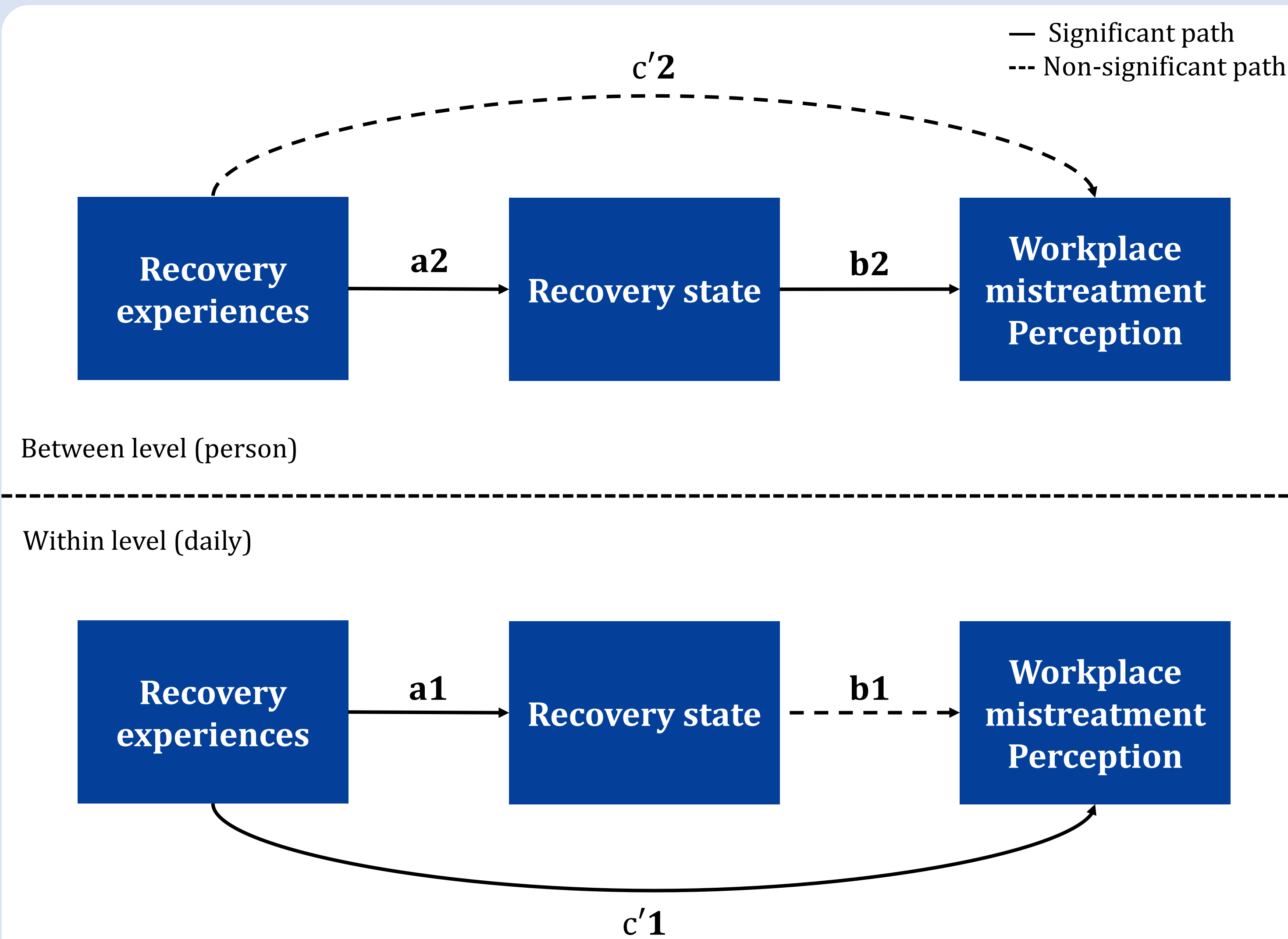


"The **accumulation of recovery** experiences builds **psychological resources** that protect nurses from **perceiving** negative workplace interactions as **mistreatment**."

## 01 BACKGROUND

- Workplace mistreatment is a prevalent source of employee strain; however, such behaviors are not always clear-cut and often require active interpretation.
- Employees' psychological resources can influence how they interpret workplace interactions, enabling more objective appraisal of ambiguous behaviors and less threat perception.
- However, psychological resources are finite and susceptible to depletion, making effective recovery essential for their replenishment.
- The present study tests whether recovery experiences enhance recovery state, which in turn reduces perceptions of workplace mistreatment at both the daily and person levels.

## 02 CONCEPTUAL MODEL



## 03 METHOD

- Participants**
  - 268 registered nurses employed at hospitals in South Korea.
- Procedure**
  - Using experience sampling methodology, two surveys per workday (an after-work survey and a before-work survey) were conducted over one month.
  - A total of 3,917 daily observations were obtained ( $M = 14.6$  days per person).
- Measures**
  - Recovery experiences: 4 items (psychological detachment, relaxation, mastery, control)
  - Recovery state: 2 items
  - Workplace mistreatment Perception: 10 items (patients/caregivers: 4 items; supervisor: 3 items; coworker: 3 items)
- Analysis**
  - Multilevel structural equation modeling using Mplus 8.9.

## 04 RESULTS

- Recovery experiences significantly predicted recovery state at both the **daily** and **person** levels.
- At the **daily level**, recovery experiences directly and negatively predicted mistreatment perception, independent of recovery state. Neither the effect of recovery state nor the indirect effect was significant.
- At the **person level**, recovery state significantly and negatively predicted mistreatment perception, and the indirect effect of recovery experiences through recovery state was significant.

| Path                                       | Estimate | SE   | 95% CI          |
|--------------------------------------------|----------|------|-----------------|
| <b>Within level (daily)</b>                |          |      |                 |
| Recovery experiences → Recovery state (a1) | .667***  | .020 | [.628, .705]    |
| Recovery state → Mistreatment (b1)         | .089     | .068 | [-.045, .223]   |
| Indirect effect (a1 × b1)                  | .060     | .046 | [-.030, .149]   |
| Recovery experiences → Mistreatment (c'1)  | -.220*   | .090 | [-.397, -.043]  |
| <b>Between level (person)</b>              |          |      |                 |
| Recovery experiences → Recovery state (a2) | .870***  | .064 | [.745, .994]    |
| Recovery state → Mistreatment (b2)         | -1.625*  | .750 | [-3.094, -.156] |
| Indirect effect (a2 × b2)                  | -1.413*  | .661 | [-2.708, -.118] |
| Recovery experiences → Mistreatment (c'2)  | .635     | .941 | [-1.209, 2.480] |

Note. All estimates are unstandardized coefficients. \*  $p < .05$ . \*\*\*  $p < .001$ .

## 05 DISCUSSION

- Recovery experience as a predictor of workplace mistreatment perception**
  - Recovery experiences predicted mistreatment perception at both levels, suggesting that how well employees recover from work extends beyond well-being outcomes to shape how they interpret interpersonal workplace events.
  - This reframes mistreatment perception as driven by a modifiable recovery state rather than fixed dispositional traits (e.g., trait NA).
- Level-dependent mechanisms linking recovery to mistreatment perception**
  - At the daily level, recovery experiences reduced mistreatment perception directly.
  - At the person level, the effect operated solely through accumulated recovery state.
  - The divergent patterns across levels call for a temporally differentiated model of how recovery shapes mistreatment perception, with daily and chronic processes operating through distinct psychological pathways.
- Future research questions**
  - Why do daily and person-level effects operate through different pathways? What mechanisms drive each?
  - Does recovery enhance perceptual accuracy, or does it merely attenuate mistreatment perception?
  - Is perceiving less mistreatment adaptive reappraisal or desensitization to genuine mistreatment?